

COMING UP NEXT

SUVs ARE CURRENTLY HOT PROPERTY—BUT WILL THIS TREND CONTINUE IN THE FACE OF INCREASING ELECTRIC VEHICLE ADOPTION ACROSS THE GLOBE?

VIKRAM PAWAH

President, BMW Group India

Q. Do you see the SUV trend continuing in India? What's next for BMW India in that respect?

BMW's sports activity vehicles (SAVs) are immensely successful because of their commanding road presence, robust proportions, elevated driving position and dynamic performance. We have SAVs in each segment, with petrol, diesel and electric powertrains. The demand is quite high with long waiting periods. The preference for luxury SAVs will increase in the future and these vehicles will remain an important pillar of our product strategy.

Q. What are BMW's plans for EVs in India?

In December, we promised to launch three EVs within 180 days. The first was the iX. It was sold out on the day of the launch. Next, we launched the Mini three-door Cooper SE, which also was completely sold out. We will soon be launching the i4.

SHASHANK SRIVASTAVA

Senior executive director (marketing and sales), Maruti Suzuki India

Q. Do you see the SUV trend continuing in India? What's next for Maruti Suzuki India?

The SUV segment has indeed seen a lot of interest. In the past few years, 45 models have been launched by various OEMs, keeping this segment most vibrant. The cost of entry-level SUVs has also fallen due to GST rate concessions. As a result, there is a price overlap between entry-level sedans and SUVs and premium hatchbacks. Hence the cross consideration for consumers have increased across segments. We also see an increased preference, globally, for SUVs due to their road presence, higher ground clearance and the space they offer. We are confident this segment will continue to garner customer interest



Q. What are Maruti Suzuki India's plans for EVs in the country?

While EV adoption is inevitable, there are certain factors—the high cost, range anxiety and the lack of charging infrastructure—that are preventing the adoption on a large scale currently. As announced earlier, Maruti Suzuki India will be launching our electric vehicle by 2025.